[AGENCY NAME / LOGO]

Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT) Program

Skills Coaching Contact - Documentation Form

Fillable form version for agency adaptation, for between-session coaching contacts by text, phone, video, or in person. Fields marked (F) correspond directly to scored items on the DBT program fidelity assessment (Skills Coaching/Crisis Intervention section).

Client Name: **Client ID / MRN:**

Date of Contact: **Individual DBT Therapist:**

Start Time: **End Time / Duration (min):**

Credential / License: **If covering therapist, Primary Therapist:**

Contact Method (check all that apply):

Text / SMS Phone call Video In person

Contact Initiated By:

Client Therapist (returning a message)

1. Availability & Orientation (F)

(Fidelity: Skills Coaching - criteria & scoring item 1)

Client has been oriented to the uses, process, and limits of therapist availability:

Yes, previously oriented Reoriented during this contact No - needs orientation

Any planned unavailability (e.g., vacation, coverage arrangements) reviewed with client:

Yes N/A - not applicable this contact

2. Safety Screen Prior to Coaching (F)

(Fidelity: Skills Coaching - criteria & scoring items 4-5)

Coaching contacts are not conducted within 24 hours of a suicide or self-harm behavior, though a client may still contact the therapist for help obtaining needed medical attention.

Self-harm / suicide behavior in the 24 hours prior to this contact assessed:

Yes No

Self-harm / suicide behavior occurred in the 24 hours prior to this contact:

No Yes

If yes, contact was limited to obtaining needed medical attention:

Yes No - clinical rationale below N/A

Clinical rationale (if contact proceeded beyond medical attention despite recent self-harm/suicide behavior):

3. Reason for Contact / TIB Screen (F)

(Fidelity: Skills Coaching - scoring item 2)

Primary reason for contact (check all that apply):

- Skills coaching - help applying skills to a current situation
- Crisis / urge to engage in target behavior - help avoiding target behavior
- Repair of therapeutic relationship - conflict or misunderstanding
- Logistical / scheduling
- Getting needed medical attention
- Other:

Is this contact itself a potential therapy-interfering behavior (e.g., pattern of calls in place of session work, avoidance, excessive frequency)?

No Yes - addressed as TIB this contact Yes - deferred to next individual session

If a TIB was identified, describe how it was assessed and/or addressed:

4. Contact Structure (F)

(Fidelity: Skills Coaching - scoring items 3 & 6)

Structure of this contact (check all that apply):

- Brief check-in / assessed client's current state
- Specific skill(s) identified and coached
- Client's plan to use the skill(s) confirmed before ending contact
- Contact kept brief and skills-focused (not extended therapy or an unstructured, reinforcing conversation)

Skill(s) coached (module / specific skill):

5. Follow-Up Plan (F)

(Fidelity: Skills Coaching - scoring item 7)

Follow-up plan established:

Yes No - rationale below

Follow-up plan / next steps:

To be discussed at next individual therapy session:

Yes No

Consultation team informed (if clinically indicated):

Yes No N/A

6. Clinical Notes

Brief summary of contact content and clinical impression:

Signature

Therapist Signature:

Credentials:

Date / Time Note Completed:

Appendix A: Fidelity Crosswalk

Reference page for clinical directors, trainers, and fidelity reviewers - remove before this note is finalized as a client-record document. Shows how each field above documents a specific item scored on the agency's DBT program fidelity assessment (Skills Coaching/Crisis Intervention section).

Note Field	Corresponding Fidelity Scale Item
Header block - Contact Method & Duration fields	Skills Coaching criteria: contacts occur 'by phone, text, or in person'; time and length of contact document that calls are 'brief and not for the purpose of conducting therapy or ... full crisis assessments.'
Section 1 - Availability & Orientation	Scoring item 1: 'therapists do not orient clients to the uses, processes, and limits of therapist availability at the beginning of treatment and in an ongoing manner.'
Section 2 - Safety Screen (24-hour rule)	Skills Coaching criteria: contacts 'are not to be conducted within 24 hours of a suicide or self-harm behavior,' with an exception for obtaining needed medical attention; scoring items 4-5.
Section 3 - Reason for Contact / TIB Screen	Scoring item 2: 'clients do not call for coaching and the therapist does not assess whether or not this is a therapy interfering behavior (TIB) and/or do not treat the TIB if defined as such.'
Section 4 - Contact Structure checklist	Scoring items 3 & 6: 'therapist does not document that they are following the structure and including critical elements of a coaching call' and does not avoid 'heart-to-heart conversations ... making calls excessively reinforcing.'
Section 5 - Follow-Up Plan	Scoring item 7: 'therapists do not document any follow up plans or lack thereof in the record of calls.'

Scoring context (from the fidelity assessment's Score Summary):

Skills Coaching/Crisis Intervention and each other domain are rated 1-5. A single missing element (e.g., no follow-up plan documented) can be enough to move a domain from a 5 to a 2-4; a pattern across records - such as coaching consistently unavailable for portions of any 24-hour period - drives a score of 1.

Program-level bands: 62-70+ = good implementation | 52-61 = fair implementation | 51 and below = not evidence-based practice.